USB BAITING ACTIVITY REPORT

Attack Vector & Social Engineering Assessment

Organization: Rhetorical Hospital
Target: HR Department Assets
Analysis Method: Isolated Virtual Sandbox

ASSESSMENT MATRIX

Contents (Stored Information)	The discovered USB drive contains a combination of sensitive work-related files and personal records belonging to HR Director Jorge Bailey. The contents include personal photos of family and pets, alongside sensitive business assets such as a new hire letter and internal employee shift schedules. This exposure reveals Personally Identifiable Information (PII) and confidential operational data.
Attacker Mindset (Exploitation & Baiting)	A threat actor could weaponize this PII to execute highly targeted spear-phishing campaigns or impersonate Jorge to manipulate hospital staff into granting unauthorized access. Furthermore, the drive could serve as an intentional baiting trap where malicious code or backdoors are planted alongside familiar documents, enticing employees to plug it into network endpoints.
Risk Analysis & Controls (Mitigation Strategy)	To mitigate USB baiting attacks, technical controls such as disabling AutoRun, blocking unauthorized removable storage via Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and enforcing hardware encryption must be deployed. Operationally, organizations must strictly isolate personal data from corporate devices and mandate sandboxed malware analysis for untrusted media. Administratively, regular security awareness training must be conducted to teach employees never to insert found storage drives into company systems.

SUMMARY & KEY TAKEAWAYS

Physical attack vectors like USB baiting exploit human curiosity and trust. Even without embedded malware, lost storage media represents a severe vulnerability due to data leakage and reconnaissance risks. Implementing layered defenses (Defense in Depth)—combining endpoint restrictions, security policies, and user awareness—effectively closes this attack surface.